

PivotHop Schweiz. Berufswechsel, vermessen.

The complete case for refocusing PivotHop as a Swiss business for the Swiss market: the rationale, the market by its numbers, the word that proves the demand, the competition map, the data plan, the go-to-market, the money, the plan with its kill criteria, and the honest arguments against. Researched and written 1 August 2026.

32/55

OCCUPATIONAL GROUPS
IN SHORTAGE

1 in 7

SWISS WORKERS CHANGED
JOBS IN 2023

CHF 1,000+

PRICE OF ONE JOBS.CH
POSTING

10–25k

CHF PER PERSON,
OUTPLACEMENT

The verdict: go Swiss-first now, staged, without burning the global boats. The niche theory holds. The demand is named, the competition is absent at our angle, the willingness to pay is the best in Europe, a federal law feeds the corpus, and the co-founder is native to the market. The two real risks, corpus acquisition and the German miner, are both testable within days and gated by explicit kill criteria.

INSIDE

02	The rationale	why now is the cheapest this pivot will ever be
03	The market, by its numbers	workforce, shortage, mobility, prices
04	The word	what "Quereinsteiger" proves about demand
05	The competition map	who owns what, and the empty seat
06	The data plan	corpus, salaries, mobility, taxonomy
07	Go-to-market and the money	who pays, how much, sold by whom
08	The plan	phases, languages, geo, entity, kill criteria
09	The case against, taken seriously	and the seven questions, answered

Why now is the cheapest this pivot will ever be.

Five arguments, in order of weight. Each is grounded in something measured, not in enthusiasm.

1 · NOTHING TO STRAND

PivotHop is pre-revenue and functionally pre-brand: Google was still serving the hosting provider's logo in search results days ago, and indexing of the 13,000-page surface is early. There are no users to migrate and no reputation to spend. The sunk cost is the engine, the miner, the quality gates, the report system, the gold-set harness, and it transfers to any market at 100%. Every month of further US-focused SEO investment raises the price of this decision; today it is near zero.

2 · THE GLOBAL LANE NOW HAS A FUNDED COMPETITOR ON OUR ARCHITECTURE

HiringCafe reached 1,000,000 monthly active users in twelve months on the same architectural bet we made independently: crawl employers directly, extract structure with an LLM, refuse aggregator feeds. Their own job board, which our scraper can read, shows them hiring a **Founding Head of SEO**, a Founding Growth Hacker, and a Founding Head of Marketing. Contesting English-language organic search against that, as a two-person shop, is the fight to decline. Their architecture also cannot produce our number: they can tell an employer who applied, not who could do the job and never applied.

3 · REVENUE IS NEARER IN SWITZERLAND

The US plan monetizes "after one paying employer" with no pipeline behind the phrase. The Swiss plan has named buyer categories with published prices: outplacement firms charging CHF 10,000–25,000 per person, cantonal RAV career services, and employers in the 32 shortage occupations who already pay CHF 1,000+ to post a single ad. All are reached the Swiss way, in person, in German, by a native co-founder who already operates our outreach.

4 · A FEDERAL LAW FEEDS THE CORPUS

The Stellenmeldepflicht obliges Swiss employers to report vacancies in occupations with elevated unemployment to the public employment service. Those reports flow into Job-Room (arbeit.swiss), SECO's portal, which exposes a documented API. Mandated coverage lands precisely where career-changers are wanted. No other market we could pick has a law that pushes job postings toward the public data source.

5 · SEQUENCING DISSOLVES THE LANGUAGE BLOCKER

The German miner (compound splitting) is real work. But Swiss tech advertises heavily in English: SwissDevJobs, englishjobsearch.ch, and the Zurich offices of companies already on the ATS platforms we scrape today. Launching with the tech vertical means the existing miner works on day one, while German lands in parallel and unlocks wave two, care and trades, where the shortage is loudest.

In one sentence: the engine was always the moat and the market was always the question, and the data says the answer is a market with a word for our user, a law that feeds our corpus, a price floor ten times the US baseline, and a co-founder native to it.

Small country, dense market, extreme prices.

~5.2M

PEOPLE IN THE
WORKFORCE

2.8%

UNEMPLOYMENT (SECO,
FEB 2026)

19.5%

LEFT THEIR JOB WITHIN
A YEAR (2024)

~700k

ANNUAL JOB MOVERS,
IMPLIED

MOBILITY: THE ADDRESSABLE POOL IS ENORMOUS RELATIVE TO THE COUNTRY

The federal statistics office (BFS/SAKE) measures occupational mobility directly: **14.7% of employed persons changed workplace between 2022 and 2023**, "one person in seven" in the BFS's own words, rising to 19.5% leaving their position in 2024 (12.9% changed jobs; 6.6% exited employment). Among 15–24-year-olds the rate is 23.8%. Movers had spent an average of 5.6 years at the previous employer, and **38.1% of changers saw their salary rise**. This is a population that changes jobs constantly, in a system that documents it obsessively.

THE SHORTAGE: MEASURED, OFFICIAL, NATIONAL NEWS

The Adecco Group / University of Zurich skills-shortage index registers shortage in **32 of 55 occupational groups**. The hardest-hit fields, IT, healthcare and care (Pflege), engineering, construction and trades, are exactly the fields most open to career-changers, and trade associations have responded by compressing retraining to 3–6 month certificates in several occupations. "Fachkräftemangel" is standing national news coverage, and the Pflegeinitiative put federal money behind care-sector retraining specifically.

WHAT EMPLOYERS PAY TODAY

ITEM	PRICE	MEANING FOR US
One posting on jobs.ch	~CHF 1,000+	the willingness-to-pay baseline for recruiting products
Outplacement, per person	CHF 10,000–25,000	customary in Swiss redundancies, often in the Sozialplan; providers buy tools
LinkedIn recruiting	enterprise pricing	dominant above ~CHF 80k roles; not a local tool, not adjacency

For contrast: the US-anonymous-web baseline for a job posting is often free to double digits. The Swiss recruiting market prices at roughly an order of magnitude above the markets we currently address, on a per-unit basis.

LANGUAGES OF THE MARKET

German-speaking Switzerland is roughly 65% of the market and hosts the shortage concentration; Romandie (French) is a distinct market with its own leading board (jobup.ch); Ticino (Italian) is small

enough to defer. Swiss tech advertises substantially in English. A quarter of Swiss residents are foreign nationals, which keeps an English UI relevant even domestically.

"Quereinsteiger" is the market research.

In English, "career changer" is a description you must explain. In the German-speaking job market, Quereinsteiger is a category the market already uses to organize itself. That single linguistic fact carries more signal than any survey we could commission.

WHAT THE WORD'S EXISTENCE PROVES

- **Employers use it in postings.** Ads are explicitly written "auch für Quereinsteiger", also for career-changers. A dedicated Swiss board, derquereinstieg.ch, lists ~425 explicitly tagged positions, with the largest categories in sales, gastronomy, IT, trades, and care.
- **Boards filter by it.** A category with its own filter is a category with search volume behind it.
- **Institutions plan around it.** Shortened retraining certificates, federal care-sector funding, and cantonal counseling all address the Quereinsteiger explicitly.
- **The concept has infrastructure in the language:** Umschulung (retraining), Berufswechsel (occupation change), eidg. Fachausweis (federal diploma). German gives our product's whole conceptual field native vocabulary; our hero pattern even translates with its period intact: **"Berufswechsel, vermessen."** / "Reconversion, mesurée."

WHY THIS MATTERS STRATEGICALLY

Products fail in translation when the category has to be taught. Here the category pre-exists and is under-served on exactly our dimension: everything the Swiss market offers the Quereinsteiger is either listings (boards), coaching (outplacement, career counseling), or retraining (schools). **Nobody offers measurement:** which moves your existing skills actually reach, what each is worth, what genuinely stands in the way. The Swiss labor market, built on documented credentials and formal pathways, is culturally primed to trust exactly the kind of evidence we produce, and our licence-gate honesty ("no amount of skill overlap shortens a credential") reads there as common sense rather than as a disclaimer.

The cultural fit in one line: we built an instrument that refuses to flatter its user, for the one job market in Europe famous for refusing to flatter anybody.

THE SEO ANGLE OF THE WORD

The German query space (Quereinstieg Pflege, Berufswechsel mit 40, Umschulung IT, was verdient ein...) is served today by content-thin guides and retraining marketers, not by data. Our pSEO machinery, category pages, route pages, salary pages, FAQ schema, transfers directly; the corpus behind it is the work. Competing in German against Swiss content is a radically easier organic fight than competing in English against the world.

Everyone owns a piece. Nobody sits in our seat.

PLAYER	WHAT THEY OWN	WHAT THEY DO NOT DO
jobs.ch / JobCloud	market leader; ~110–150k ads, 2.9M monthly visits; with JobScout24 covers most of the German-speaking board market	no measurement, no adjacency, no career-change product; sells listings
jobup.ch (JobCloud)	Romandie leader	same: listings
LinkedIn	professional recruiting above ~CHF 80k; multinationals, finance	global tool, no Swiss credential system, no honest gap measurement
x28 AG	crawls ~250k postings from employer sites; sells data (powers job-radar.ch and the academic Swiss Job Tracker)	data vendor, not a consumer product; a potential supplier, not a rival
Jobich.ch	AI aggregation across 43+ boards, four languages	aggregation only; the syndication echo we refuse
derquereinstieg.ch	the career-changer niche board; proves the category	hobby-scale listings; no data product, no measurement
SwissDevJobs	tech niche with salary transparency; started as a side project	one vertical, no adjacency; also proof a Swiss niche board can sustain itself
Outplacement firms (Grass & Partner, Alixio Mobility, LHH, Right Management, von Rohr)	the paid career-transition relationship, CHF 10–25k per person	coaching businesses with thin tooling; buyers, not competitors

THE EMPTY SEAT

Across the entire map there is no product that answers the Quereinsteiger's actual first question, **"which careers do my existing skills already reach, and what exactly is missing?"**, with measurement rather than opinion. jobs.ch tells you what exists. LinkedIn tells you who you know. Outplacement tells you what a coach thinks. The seat we occupy in every market, the instrument, is empty in this one, and in this one the surrounding players are either suppliers (x28, Job-Room) or customers (outplacement, RAV) rather than rivals.

AND THE INCUMBENT THREAT IS STRUCTURALLY SLOW

JobCloud could build adjacency measurement; it would cannibalize nothing and help them, but boards optimize for listing revenue and have for twenty years. HiringCafe could localize; nothing in their coverage-race roadmap points at a 5M-worker, four-language market. The realistic competitive risk is a

copycat after we prove the category, which is the same risk everywhere, met the same way: the corpus, the taxonomy judgement, and the local relationships compound daily.

The corpus is the gate. Here is the gate plan.

Adzuna, 75% of our current corpus, does not operate in Switzerland. A Swiss PivotHop starts near zero postings, and everything downstream, the graph, the readiness numbers, the board, depends on fixing that. This is the pivot's critical path.

SOURCES, IN THE ORDER WE TRY THEM

#	SOURCE	WHAT / HOW	COST
1	Job-Room API (arbeit.swiss)	SECO's portal; documented API at api.job-room.ch ; fed by the Stellenmeldepflicht, so coverage is legally mandated in high-unemployment occupations. First action: the Swiss partner emails jobroom-api@seco.admin.ch for read access.	free (verify terms)
2	Direct employer crawl	our existing Greenhouse / Lever / Ashby adapters against Swiss offices and scale-ups; SwissDevJobs-listed companies; English tech ads work in the miner today	free
3	Bridge scrapers	Apify actors exist for arbeit.swiss and JobScout24; usable to validate volume while access questions resolve	~usage-priced
4	x28 AG	the "buy the corpus" option: ~250k postings crawled from employer sites, API access sold commercially	paid; cap CHF ~300/mo
×	jobs.ch scraping	scraping the company we would later want as a partner, against its terms	refused

SALARIES: THE SWISS TWIST THAT BECOMES AN UPGRADE

Swiss ads famously omit pay, which would blind our posted-band method. The replacement is better for this market: the **BFS Lohnstrukturhebung / Salarium**, the federal wage-structure survey, public, official, per occupation, region, age and seniority. "The federal statistics say" outranks "179 postings state pay" for Swiss credibility, and it is free.

MOBILITY: AN OFFICIAL SOURCE EXISTS HERE TOO

Our US worker-flow data does not transfer, but the BFS publishes **occupational mobility as open data**, including gross and net rotation rates by occupational group (SAKE / opendata.swiss). Switzerland may end up the market where our "commonly done" signal is fed by official statistics rather than survey panels. Until wired, routes launch honestly with mobility labeled EU-observed.

TAXONOMY: ALREADY HALF-BRIDGED

The Swiss system runs on CH-ISCO-19 (BFS) and ~230 federally recognized apprenticeship professions with a public register of regulated occupations (SBFI). Our taxonomy already carries an ISCO crosswalk

([isco-crosswalk.json](#)), which is the Swiss classification's own spine; the work is extension and per-
occupation care, not invention. The licence-gate model maps one-to-one onto reglementierte Berufe.

B2C free. B2B pays. Sold in person, in German.

THE BUYER MAP

BUYER	WHY THEY PAY	WHAT WE SELL THEM
Outplacement firms Grass & Partner, Alixio Mobility (ex-von Rundstedt), LHH/Adecco, Right Management, von Rohr, Dr. Nadig, Mangold	they charge CHF 10–25k per person and compete on tooling and outcomes; the NZZ quote from the industry: employers "want a clone of the predecessor", the counselor's job is widening the search	the instrument as counselor tooling: per-client route reports, white-label PDF, seat licences
RAV / cantonal employment services	legally mandated counseling for job-seekers; measurable placement targets; already operate Job-Room	counselor licences; the honest-odds instrument for mandated career advice
Employers in shortage occupations	32/55 groups cannot fill roles; already pay CHF 1,000+ per posting for silence	the adjacent-talent board: "who could do this job and never applied", concierge first, product later
The Quereinsteiger (B2C)	free	the instrument and report; the audience that makes the B2B credible, and the SEO surface that makes us findable

A PRICING SKETCH, DELIBERATELY MODEST

- **Counselor seat** (outplacement / RAV): CHF 90–150 per counselor per month; a rounding error against one CHF 15k mandate, priced to be signed without procurement.
- **Employer adjacent-talent introduction** (concierge VO): CHF 300–500 per shortlist, manually assembled exactly as docs/00 prescribes; product-ize only after repeat purchase.
- **B2C stays free**, including the PDF. In this market the report is the demo the counselor sees.

Reference math: ten counselor seats and two concierge employers is roughly CHF 1,500–2,500 per month, real second-income territory, reachable without a single viral anything, sold through perhaps a dozen in-person conversations.

CHANNELS THAT ARE ACTUALLY SWISS

- **The partner, in person.** Swiss B2B trusts a Swiss face, a .ch domain, CHF invoices, and patience. She already runs our outreach operation; the GmbH makes her the face of a Swiss company, which is the local-trust thesis made flesh.
- **HR press and events:** hrtoday.ch, Handelszeitung, HR Festival; the launch data-post ("we measured every open Swiss position for what it actually demands") is uncopiable and press-shaped.

- **German pSEO** on the Quereinstieg query space, currently served by content, not data.

Staged, gated, reversible by construction.

PHASE 0 · VERIFY (DAYS 1-14, COST: ONE EMAIL)

- Partner emails jobroom-api@seco.admin.ch for read access, from the Swiss side, in German.
- In parallel: point existing ATS adapters at Swiss companies; run one bridge-scraper volume test on arbeit.swiss.
- Wire the country=CH slice through the existing pipeline (the corpus already carries country inference).

PHASE 1 · THE SWISS TECH EDITION (WEEKS 2-7)

- Corpus: CH tech postings (English-heavy, miner works today) + Job-Room flow if granted.
- German miner phase 2: compound splitting (head-final, the mirror of the Spanish reorder), gold-set gated like every miner change.
- pivothop.ch: German landing ("Berufswechsel, vermessen."), locale routes /de /fr /en, hreflang; geo-**suggestion** banner via the x-vercel-ip-country header, never a forced redirect.
- Salarium wiring for Swiss salary bands; BFS mobility data scoped.

PHASE 2 · THE MARKET THAT PAYS (WEEKS 6-13, OVERLAPPING)

- Entity: GmbH (or Einzelfirma first) with the partner as the Swiss face; CHF invoicing.
- First three outplacement conversations from the named list; RAV approach through one canton.
- Wave 2 vertical: Pflege, once German mapping clears its gold set; the honesty moat is deepest there.
- Launch data-post in German for the press channel.

KILL CRITERIA, AGREED IN ADVANCE

GATE	CONDITION TO CONTINUE	OTHERWISE
Day 14	Job-Room access answered OR a bridge path delivering ≥10k CH postings	pause; price x28 against the CHF 300/mo cap before any further build
Day 45	≥25k CH postings in corpus AND German titles mapping ≥55%	reassess scope (tech-only edition vs full market)
Day 90	one Swiss B2B conversation showing pilot interest	revert to global-only, which never stopped running

Reversibility is structural: the global nightly machine, the MCP surface and the English site keep operating untouched throughout. Reverting means stopping new Swiss work, not rebuilding anything.

The strongest arguments against, taken seriously.

- **The market is small.** 5.2M workers; the B2C ceiling is a fraction of the US. True, and irrelevant to the thesis: the plan monetizes B2B depth (tens of customers at Swiss prices), not consumer volume. The theory was never scale; it was a defensible niche that pays.
- **The corpus could fail.** Job-Room access is unverified; x28 may price above a hobby budget. This is the real risk, which is why it is the day-14 gate and why the first franc is capped. If both paths fail, the pivot dies cheaply and early, by design.
- **B2B sales cycles are slow and personal.** Months, in German, in person. This bets on the partner's time and appetite, the single biggest unknown in the whole plan, and the reason question 4 below matters more than any technical one.
- **German is deceptively hard for the miner.** Compound splitting, Swiss-German ad idiom, apprenticeship titles with no US equivalent. Mitigated by the tech-first sequencing and the gold-set discipline, but the 55%-mapping gate exists because this can slip.
- **Two-market attention split.** The global machine is automated, but attention is not; the discipline is that no NEW global feature work happens during the Swiss push.

THE SEVEN QUESTIONS, ANSWERED

1 • Full pivot or edition?

Swiss-first business on the global engine. The nightly, the MCP and the English surface keep running at zero marginal cost as method-proof.

2 • Which language first?

Deutschschweiz regardless (65% of market, the shortage concentration). If the partner is Romandie-native, ship DE+FR together; jobup territory rewards a native voice.

3 • Pay for data?

Yes, capped at ~CHF 300/month, and only after the free path fails. Day one costs one email.

4 • Who sells?

The partner. She already runs outreach; the GmbH makes her the Swiss face. Engineering, data and product stay on this side of the table.

5 • Which vertical first?

IT first, for data reasons and because the name carries there. Pflege second, once German lands: biggest shortage, federal money, and the market where honest licence gates embarrass the retraining marketers.

6 • Kill criteria?

Day 14 / 45 / 90 as on page 08, agreed before the first hour is spent.

7 • Does the name carry?

Keep PivotHop with the German tagline for the tech launch; revisit only if the Pflege wave tests badly against the anglicism.

Everything cited.

Researched 1 August 2026. Figures are as published by the sources below; where a number is our own inference (the ~700k implied annual movers; the pricing sketch) it is labeled as such in the text. Nothing in this dossier is invented, and the two numbers that could not be verified (x28 pricing; Job-Room read-access terms) are named as open rather than estimated.

MARKET AND MOBILITY

BFS / SAKE, "Berufliche Mobilität": one person in seven changed workplace 2022–2023 (14.7%); 19.5% left their position within 2024 (12.9% changed jobs); 23.8% among 15–24; 5.6 years average tenure before a change; 38.1% of changers with higher salary. Mobility data available via opendata.swiss including rotation rates by occupational group. · **SECO**: unemployment ~2.8% (Feb 2026). · **Adecco Group / University of Zurich skills-shortage index**: shortage in 32 of 55 occupational groups (via weka.ch, ki-blick.ch coverage).

BOARDS AND COMPETITION

Upreer "Best Job Boards Switzerland 2026" and **join.com** Swiss job-sites guide: jobs.ch ~110k+ ads, 2.9M monthly visits, JobCloud family structure, jobup.ch Romandie position, JobScout24 SME/eastern coverage, LinkedIn's role above ~CHF 80k. · **derquereinstieg.ch**: ~425 explicitly Quereinsteiger-tagged positions and category structure. · **SwissDevJobs**, **englishjobsearch.ch**, **it-jobs-switzerland.ch**: the English-language tech ad market. · **Jobich.ch**: aggregation across 43+ boards.

DATA INFRASTRUCTURE

Job-Room API documentation (test-api.job-room.ch, api.job-room.ch; contact jobroom-api@seco.admin.ch) and **arbeit.swiss** Stellenmeldepflicht pages. · **x28 AG** (services; ~250k crawled postings; powers.job-radar.ch) and the **Swiss Job Tracker** methodology paper. · **Apify** actors for arbeit.swiss and JobScout24 (bridge scrapers). · **BFS Salarium / Lohnstrukturerhebung** for official wages; **CH-ISCO-19** and the **SBFI** register of regulated professions for taxonomy.

OUTPLACEMENT

KarriereMentor and **bewerbung.net**: CHF 10,000–25,000 per person at the large providers. · **hrtoday.ch** and **NZZ** market coverage; provider set: Grass & Partner, Alixio Mobility (formerly von Rundstedt Schweiz), LHH (Adecco), Right Management (Manpower), von Rohr & Associates, Dr. Nadig & Partner, Mangold.

CAREER - CHANGER DEMAND

derquereinstieg.ch and **FunkyJobs** Quereinstieg guides; retraining compressed to 3–6 month certificates in several trades; Quereinsteiger salary spans CHF 52,000 (care assistance) to CHF 100,000+ (B2B sales, data roles).

Companion documents in the knowledge base: [docs/32-switzerland.md](#) (this dossier's source of truth), [docs/27](#) (multilingual miner architecture), [docs/00](#) (concierge V0 model), [docs/12](#) (kill-criteria discipline).